

Forward plan — reading order and glossary

Canonical name: 01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md

Date: 2026-06-25 (updated)

From: COMPASS

To: Charles Levine

Purpose: Glossary and jargon decoder.

Print stack: use Charles_reading_list.md for the full ordered list (must-read #1–#6 vs reference #7–#13).

Advisor framing: Alex Gates = guidance · Dakota Murray = decision points (not automatic path changes).

Start here if lost: Charles_reading_list.md → this file (glossary) → read must-read #2–#6 in full.

Numbered active docs (quick map)

#	File	Role
01	01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md	This file — glossary
02	02_Charles_decisions_locked.md	Your Tier 1 locks (already filed)
03	03_Where_we_are_now.md	Project status today
04	04_Project_story_plain_English.md	Plain-English story
05	../5-Manuscript/05_Model_Nesting_Note_v1.md	One ontology $L_{\text{net}} = B - D$
06	06_Generative_closure_checklist.md	SCOUT C1–C8 checklist
07	07_Claim_language_guardrails.md	What you may / may not claim
08	08_Basketball_figures_on_disk.md	D10 bundle file list
09	09_Tenure_export_on_disk.md	Inference export numbers
10	../5-Manuscript/10_Manuscript_ink_map.md	Section routing for Word
11	../5-Manuscript/11_Dakota_feedback_decision_points.md	Dakota email → evaluate, not auto-follow
12	../5-Manuscript/12_Manuscript_staging_prose.md	Copy-from paragraphs
13	13_INSIGHT_NUGGETS.md	Pivotal framing (optional skim)

Long original names → `obsolete/original_filenames/`.

Returning after a break (June 2026) — use this path

Tier 1 already filed in `02_Charles_decisions_locked.md`. Phase A exports done. **Do not re-litigate locks.**

Follow `Charles_reading_list.md`: must-read **#1–#6** in full, then keep **#7–#13** as reference while inking Word.

Deep-dive reading order (optional — original correspondence arc)

Use only if you want the full history behind the locks. **Not required** for manuscript inking.

Step	Document	Read for
0a	<code>13_INSIGHT_NUGGETS.md</code>	Pivotal perspectives
0b	<code>docs/Menger/</code>	Menger deep read (optional)
0	This file	Glossary
1	<code>04_Project_story_plain_English.md</code>	Plain-English story
2	<code>20260615_1045_COMPASS_to_Charles_forward_plan_and_questions.md</code>	Original action plan; §6–§7 locks (superseded by #02)
3	<code>20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md</code>	Alex PD12: four priorities
4	<code>20260615_1200_COMPASS_PD12_reassessment.md</code>	Ladder relabel; B-lite closure
5	<code>07_Claim_language_guardrails.md</code>	Claim discipline — §E, §F
6	<code>06_Generative_closure_checklist.md</code>	Green/yellow checklist

Skip for first pass: Round 1–5 correspondence in `obsolete/`; long overlap in `03_Where_we_are_now.md` vs #04.

Two different “Tier” systems

Docs use **Tier** for two unrelated things. Check context.

A. Scientific tiers (story arc)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1	Phenomenon — inverted-U on LOO proxy (mostly done)
Tier 2	Minimal mechanism — generative POC; D10 packages it
Tier 2.5	Model-guided features — quality vs congestion (PD12)
Tier 3	Predictions — named candidates, not fully proven
Tier 4	Manuscript — write the paper

B. Question tiers (your decisions — forward plan §6)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1 questions	Answer first — unblocks SCOUT, PEER, VECTOR (§6 items 1–10)
Tier 2 questions	Softer prose/methods — OK to say “ use agent defaults ” (§6 items 11+)
Tier 3+	Alex meeting, AWS, optional routes — not blocking this week

Tier 1 question IDs (memorize these five blocks):

- **SCOUT**: Q-SCOUT-9 (folder path), Q-D10 (go on export bundle)
- **PEER**: C1 (OpenAlex tiers), C2 (CSV names)
- **VECTOR**: C12–C13 (predictions + outline), V1–V3 (manuscript priority + timing)
- **COMPASS**: Q-DEFAULTS (accept Tier 2 defaults?)

Status: Answered in `02_Charles_decisions_locked.md`.

Rung / ladder (plain English)

Not a code pipeline. Steps in the paper argument, in order:

Rung 1	Phenomenon	→ inverted-U exists (Army, basketball; tenure preliminary)
Rung 2	Minimal model	→ talent-only fails; congestion-in-score POC (basketball)
Rung 2.5	Model-guided feats	→ quality vs congestion columns (mostly built; D10 exports)
Rung 3	Predictions	→ #1 near-threshold, #2 $\wedge$ – candidates, not fully validated
Rung 4	Manuscript	→ ink Word under Path II

Ladder = climb these rungs when writing; do not jump from “we found a curve” to “submit the paper” without the middle steps Alex (PD12) cares about.

Paths (manuscript architecture)

Path	Meaning	v1?
Path II (locked)	3 empirical inverted-U legs + one basketball generative POC; honest axis mismatch	Yes
Path I	Generative sim must match LOO pool-quality axis bin-for-bin	No — parallel / post-v1

Path II = Charles's “**manuscript-first**” lock (2026-06-11).

Predictions #1 and #2 (Charles clarification)

Agents locked **two prediction slots** for manuscript structure — **not** “two proven results.”

#	Name	Empirical status today
#1	Near-threshold heterogeneity	Candidate. Basketball has exploratory 4D figure; not formal cross-domain test.
#2	Peak shift with Λ	Placeholder / prose hook. No finished Λ figure in repo.

Do say: “primary prediction **directions**.”

Do not say: “predictions are fully validated across all settings” (see `07_Claim_language_guardrails.md` §F).

Shorthand glossary

Term	Plain English
COMPASS	Cross-project planner — sequencing, not domain code
CODA	Army agent
SCOUT	Basketball agent
PEER	Tenure agent
VECTOR	Your online ChatGPT Scholar agent (manuscript voice); also used as repo role label
PD12	Alex Gates paper-directions meeting, 2026-05-20
STANDING BY	Agent done debating; waiting on Charles only
Correspondence experiment	Rounds 1–5 agent mail — complete (in <code>obsolete/</code>)
LOO	Leave-one-out — peer pool excluding yourself
<code>poolq_loo</code>	LOO teammate pool quality (main empirical x-axis)
<code>crowding_smooth</code>	LOO congestion — density of viable peers above threshold
Λ (Lambda)	Global distinction capacity (slots, boards, draft picks)
D10	SCOUT export script — figures/tables in <code>08_Basketball_figures_on_disk.md</code>
Claim table	<code>07_Claim_language_guardrails.md</code>
B-lite closure	Mechanism POC + model-guided measurement + prediction readout + honest limits + D10
Axis table	Maps model quantity ↔ empirical column ↔ setting (in D10 bundle)
Wang structure	Paper arc: phenomenon → mechanism → predictions
Wang move	Predict something you did not use to find the curve
Layer B	Tenure Cox cells 10–12 in <code>540</code> — pre- submission , not draft blocker
Dakota Murray v03	Committee RTF spine + <code>10_Manuscript_ink_map.md</code>
Generative POC	Small sim showing talent-only fails and congestion bends curves

Term	Plain English
Pool mean	Whole-roster average — generative readout axis (≠ LOO axis)
SCOUT C1	Talent-only generative baseline fails — see 06_Generative_closure_checklist.md
PEER C1	OpenAlex HIGH+MEDIUM tiers for tenure — see 02_Charles_decisions_locked.md

What to do after reading (June 2026)

- 1. Open [5-Manuscript/Manuscript_working_outline_v1.docx](#)
 - 2. Ink §5 → §1 → §4 using #10, #12, #08, and #11 before §4
 - 3. Message COMPASS: “back in the game”
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Glossary companion to [Charles_reading_list.md](#).